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## BUSINESS

# A Brief History of The 4 Industrial Revolutions that Shaped the World

iED Team | 30 June 2019 | 7 min(s) read

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Throughout history, people have always been **dependent on technology**. Of course, the technology of each era might not have the same shape and size as today, but for their time, it was certainly something for people to look at.

People would always use the technology they had available to help make their lives easier and at the same time try to perfect it and bring it to the next level. This is how the concept of the industrial revolution began. Right now, we are going through the **fourth industrial revolution**, aka Industry 4.0, where we are witnessing the rise of tech & **web design companies**.

Here is a little information on the three previous industrial revolutions leading to today!

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## olution of 1765

wed the proto-industrialization period. It  
ury to the beginning of the 19<sup>th</sup>. The biggest  
the form of mechanization. Mechanization was  
aced by the industry as the backbone of the

At the time, people witnessed massive extraction of coal along with the significant invention of the steam engine that created a new type of energy that later on helped speed up the manufacturing of railroads, thus accelerating the economy.

## The Second Industrial Revolution of 1870

Following the first Industrial Revolution, we see the world go through the second almost a century later. It started at the end of the 19th century, with massive technological advancements in industries that helped the emergence of a new source of energy—electricity, gas, and oil.

This revolution resulted in the creation of the internal combustion engine that started to reach its full potential. Other important points of the second industrial revolution were the development of steel demand, chemical synthesis and [methods of communication](#) such as the telegraph and the telephone.

Finally, the inventions of the automobile and the plane at the beginning of the 20<sup>th</sup> century are the reason why, to this day, the Second Industrial Revolution is considered the most important one!

## The Third Industrial Revolution 1969

Another century passes, and we bear witness to the Third Industrial Revolution. In the second half of the 20<sup>th</sup> century, we see the emergence of yet another source of untapped, at the time, energy. [Nuclear energy](#)!

The third revolution brought forth the rise of electronics, telecommunications and, of course, computers. The third industrial revolution opened the doors to space expeditions, research, and biotechnology through the new technologies.

In the world of the industries, two major inventions, Programmable Logic Controllers (PLCs) and Robots, helped give rise to an era of high-level automation.

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the fourth Industrial Revolution, although a large we were to view Industry 4.0 as a revolution, we revolution happening now. We are experiencing it unknown.

Industry 4.0 started at the dawn of the third millennium with the one thing everyone uses every day—the Internet. We can see the transition from the first industrial revolution rooted in technological phenomena to Industry 4.0 that develops virtual reality worlds, allowing us to bend the laws of physics.

The 4 Industrial Revolutions shape the world. Worldwide economies are based on them. Programmes and projects are being implemented worldwide, focusing on helping people take advantage of the marvels of the **fourth revolution** during their everyday lives. From **digital flipbooks** to augmented reality gaming, the future is bright!

Projects like the **RESTART project** are being funded by the EU, aiming to involve the industrial sector in the transformation of VET systems to meet the need for digital skills consistent with the technological developments in industries.

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